

Word Ladders

Change ONE letter each step — grades 4-6

Name _____

Date _____

Start at the top word. Change **one letter** on each step to make a new real word, until you reach the bottom word.

Ladder 1

S	H	O	U	T
S	P	I	C	E

Ladder 2

F	L	O	C	K
T	H	A	N	K

Ladder 3

F	L	I	C	K
S	T	I	L	L

Ladder 4

B	U	N	C	H
P	L	A	T	E

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Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

S	H	O	U	T
S	H	O	R	T
S	H	O	R	E
S	H	O	N	E
S	H	I	N	E
S	P	I	N	E
S	P	I	C	E

Ladder 2

F	L	O	C	K
C	L	O	C	K
C	L	I	C	K
C	H	I	C	K
T	H	I	C	K
T	H	I	N	K
T	H	A	N	K

Ladder 3

F	L	I	C	K
S	L	I	C	K
S	T	I	C	K
S	T	A	C	K
S	T	A	L	K
S	T	A	L	L
S	T	I	L	L

Ladder 4

B	U	N	C	H
B	E	N	C	H
B	E	A	C	H
P	E	A	C	H
P	E	A	C	E
P	L	A	C	E
P	L	A	T	E